

In 2019 the department commissioned Ernst & Young to undertake an independent review of the costs of our export certification activities. These costs were set out in the 2020-21 [food and plant export Cost Recovery Implementation Statements \(CRIS\)](#). This review informed our [public consultation on the CRISs](#).

## Timing

Ernst & Young developed the report in 2019 and early 2020 – it contains data and information relevant to that time. The report was delivered in March 2020.

## The Independent Review of the Cost of Export Certification – Report 2020

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## Objectives

This review focused on food and plant export cost recovery. It did not include the live animal exports CRIS.

The independent reviewer:

- engaged with industry representatives for their views on how efficiently and effectively we deliver food and plant export certification regulatory functions
- investigated key cost drivers and consider other ways we can deliver our key regulatory functions more cost effectively
- assessed possible reported or discovered inefficiencies and recommend how we can improve our regulatory functions, including the use of technology solutions
- developed a benchmarking framework based on comparable public and private sector regulatory activities.

## Scope

The review considered other relevant reviews, analysis and policies. This included:

- importing country requirements
- the Australian Government Cost Recovery Guidelines
- the government's policy to achieve and maintain full cost recovery of export certification activity
- our broader policy and regulatory obligations
- relevant analysis and costings of our cost recovery arrangements
- Australian National Audit Office (ANAO) and industry commissioned reports from 2015.

## About the reviewer

Dean Yates is a Partner and Victorian Government Leader for Ernst & Young. To learn more about Dean visit the [Ernst & Young website](#).

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/about/fees/cost-recovery/independent-review-cost-export-certification>